

Mandarin Chinese Basics

First words and sentences · Equigrow short notes

Script

Written with characters (hànzì); **pinyin** (Latin letters with tone marks) shows pronunciation. Start with pinyin and tones.

Greetings & phrases

Phrase	Meaning
Nǐ hǎo	Hello
Wǒ jiào ...	My name is ...
Xièxie	Thank you
Duìbuqǐ	Sorry
Zàijiàn	Goodbye

Numbers 1-10

yī, èr, sān, sì, wǔ, liù, qī, bā, jiǔ, shí

Getting started

- **Four tones** change meaning: mā (high), má (rising), mǎ (dip), mà (falling).
- No verb conjugation or plurals; word order is subject – verb – object.
- HSK levels measure progress.